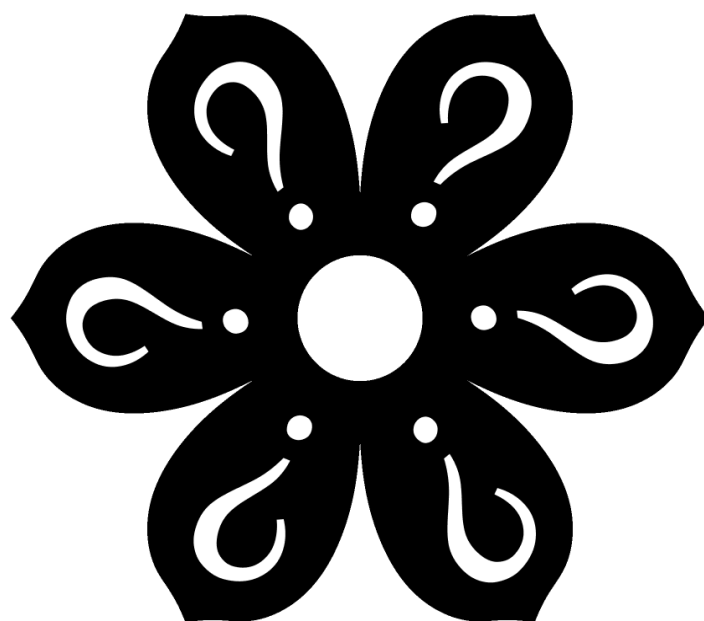




GRADWRITE

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PACK 7

6-Part Blitz

1. What title phenomenon was depicted in Prussian blue in a woodblock print by Hokusai, in which it is seen cresting off the shores of Kanagawa?

A: Great Wave

2. A number which repeats the line "welcome to a show about death" appears at the beginning of what musical about Lydia's encounters with the title demon?

A: Beetlejuice

3. Skunks, rabbits, and other animals that are only active during dusk and dawn are described by what term, in contrast to diurnal and nocturnal animals?

A: crepuscular

4. *Riftbound* is a trading card game set in the universe of what video game, which is also the setting of the television show *Arcane*?

A: League of Legends (prompt: League)

5. An heir to the Hyatt Hotels fortune, what billionaire is the current governor of Illinois?

A: J.B. Pritzker

6. What river that flows through Baghdad forms the Shatt al-Arab at its confluence with the Euphrates?

A: Tigris

Set of 4: Crosses

7. What cardinal direction is found in the common name of a cross-shaped constellation found on the flags of Papua New Guinea and Australia?

A: Southern

8. The magnitude of the cross product of two vectors is equal to the area of what type of shape defined by the two vectors?

A: parallelogram

9. St. Pancras station shares a building and Tube station with what central London railway station?

A: London King's Cross (accept: King's Cross station)

10. In genetics, what type of eponymous diagram depicts the possible outcomes of a test cross?

A: Punnett square

Jackpot

11.

Part 1: What writer was inspired by frequent visits to Margate Sands to pen part of a poem which repeats part of the line "O Lord Thou pluckest me out"?

Part 2: Bo Burnham's song "Repeat Stuff" opens by comparing the evening sky to a "patient etherized upon a table", quoting the antisocial title character of one of this man's poems.

Part 3: Images of straw men in "death's dream kingdom" appear in a poem by this poet which concludes by suggesting the world will end "not with a bang but a whimper."

Part 4: This poet wrote "The Hollow Men," "The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock," and *The Waste Land*.

A: Thomas Stearns Eliot

Set of 3: Dwarf Planets

14. Nix, Hydra, Kerberos, Styx, and the enormous Charon ["CARE-on"] are moons of what dwarf planet, once considered the ninth planet in the Solar System?

A: Pluto

15. What torus-shaped region containing the dwarf planet Ceres spans the space between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter?

A: main asteroid belt (accept: main belt)

16. Dysnomia is the only known moon of what most massive dwarf planet in the Solar System?

A: Eris

Double Jump

17. What series of 15th-century conflicts was fought between the House of Lancaster and the House of York for the English throne?

A: Wars of the Roses (reject: War of the Roses)

18. Both the Lancasters and Yorks were cadet branches of what larger former royal house of England?

A: Plantagenet

Double Jump

19. How would you spell the name of a *Dungeons & Dragons* cantrip which allows clerics to manifest a minor supernatural wonder, thaumaturgy ["THAW-mah-tur-jee"]?

A: T-H-A-U-M-A-T-U-R-G-Y

20. How do you spell the name of a *Dungeons & Dragons* cantrip which allows druids to imbue a wooden quarterstaff with nature's power, shillelagh ["shah-LAY-luh"]?

A: S-H-I-L-L-E-L-A-G-H

5-Part Mystery Link

21. What kind of clothing item can come in A-line, bubble, and ballerina varieties?

A: skirts

22. A canon in which all voices sing exactly the same melody, only staggered, is known by what term?

A: round

23. What stretch of road in Clark County contains hotels like the Venetian, the Bellagio, and Caesar's Palace?

- A: the Las Vegas **Strip** (accept: the **Strip**) (prompt: Las Vegas)
24. What nickname is shared by a famous martial artist and actor and by the anthropomorphic, animatronic rat mascot of a children's birthday restaurant?
- A: **Chuck**
25. The Algonquian word for "to knock down" is a possible origin for the name of what type of weapon?
- A: **tomahawk**

All answerlines are cuts of steak.

END OF FIRST QUARTER

SECOND QUARTER

Splits: The Tokugawa Shogunate & 2026 Hip-Hop

The Tokugawa Shogunate

26. The only foreign power allowed to have contact with Japan from the 1640s onwards was what Western European state?
- A: the **Netherlands** (accept: **Dutch** Republic)
27. What name, often used to refer to the Tokugawa period in general, comes from the name of the city which served as the shogun's home and the de facto capital of Japan before it was renamed to Tokyo?
- A: **Edo** period
28. What name is given to the last years of the Tokugawa shogunate, which came to a close following the defeat of pro-Shogunate forces during the Boshin War?
- A: **Bakumatsu** period
29. The Tokugawa Shogunate was ended by what Emperor, who transformed Japan into an industrialised nation during his namesake "restoration"?
- A: Emperor **Meiji** (accept: **Mutsuhito**)

2026 Hip-Hop

30. The song "Body To Body" samples what traditional Korean folk song, also the namesake of the album it features on, the most recent album by BTS?
- A: **Arirang**
31. What album, whose initial "V1" release in 2025 was taken down partially due to its AI-generated vocals on songs like "Preacher Man", was fully released in 2026 by Kanye West?
- A: **Bully**

32. What upcoming album's release date was hidden inside a 25-foot-tall ice structure placed in a Toronto parking lot by Drake?

A: **Iceman**

33. The mixtape *The Boy Who Cried Terrified* was released in anticipation for the debut studio album of what London underground rapper who rose to prominence for his song "Easter Pink"?

A: **fakemink** (accept: Vincenzo **Camille**)

Set of 3: Psychological Experiments Involving Children

34. Children were put into a group and forced to compete against another group in what demonstration of realistic conflict theory, which is known by the name of the state park in which it was conducted?

A: **Robbers Cave** experiment

35. What process, which John B. Watson demonstrated in humans in his Little Albert experiment, was famously demonstrated in dogs by Ivan Pavlov?

A: **classical conditioning** (prompt: conditioning)

36. The "three mountains problem" helps classify children according to the four developmental stages proposed by what Swiss psychologist?

A: Jean **Piaget**

Unrevealed Set of 4

37. What animal's name is found in an alliterative phrase describing an artist's final work before their death?

A: **swan**

The remaining questions will be related to swans.

38. A total of 42 "swans a swimming" are gifted by the singer's "true love" over the title time period of what holiday song?

A: "The **Twelve Days of Christmas**"

39. What American author's novel *Answered Prayers* exposed the scandals of his socialite friends, whom he referred to as his "swans"?

A: Truman **Capote**

40. What Hans Christian Andersen fairy tale tells the story of its title bird's transformation into a swan?

A: "The **Ugly Duckling**"

Double Jump

41. During his tenure as the director of the National Conservatory of Music of America, what Czech composer wrote the "New World" Symphony?

A: Antonin **Dvořák** ["duh-VORE-zhak"]

42. What pioneer of Czech nationalist music wrote *The Moldau* as part of his symphonic cycle *My Fatherland*?

A: Bedřich **Smetana**

Double Jump

43. What word can mean either a large group of people or livestock moving towards something, or the past tense of drive?

A: **drove**

44. What word can mean either a grueling trial, as in a military punishment, or protective gloves typically worn during combat?

A: **gauntlet**

6-Part Chain

45. Etobicoke ["uh-TOE-buh-COE"] North is the provincial riding represented by what current Premier of Ontario?

A: Doug **Ford**

46. What letter names the car which remains today the all-time most-sold car manufactured by Ford?

A: **T**

47. What British Prime Minister apocryphally names a bergamot-flavoured blend of black tea?

A: Charles **Grey**, 2nd Earl Grey (accept: Earl **Grey**)

48. What Asian-Canadian actress plays cardiothoracic surgeon Dr. Cristina Yang in *Grey's Anatomy*?

A: Sandra **Oh**

49. In what city do Jackson Holliday, Gunnar Henderson, and the rest of the MLB team known as "The O's" play?

A: **Baltimore**

50. The *Corny Collins* dance TV show features in what musical, whose opening song is "Good Morning Baltimore"?

A: **Hairspray**

END OF FIRST HALF

THIRD QUARTER

Splits: Death in Religion & Abbreviations in Computer Architecture

Death in Religion

51. Following a death, people of what religion observe a seven-day period of mourning called Shiva, from the Hebrew word for seven?

A: **Judaism**

52. What four-word English phrase is used to refer to a funerary text containing spells to help a deceased person through the Duat, when preceded by "Egyptian"?

A: **book of the dead**

53. What Arabic word is used to refer to heaven in the Qur'an?

A: **Jannah**

54. Who became the first person to die in the Bible when he was killed by his brother Cain?

A: **Abel**

Abbreviations in Computer Architecture

55. In both ROM and RAM, what does the "M" stand for?

A: **memory**

56. What 3-letter initialism refers to the primary processor of a computer?

A: **CPU**

57. What component in a PC stores data on flash memory chips, in contrast to the spinning magnetic disks in HDDs?

A: **SSDs** (accept: **solid state drives**)

58. Informed by the control unit of which operation to execute, what core component of the CPU performs bitwise operations on binary numbers?

A: **ALUs** (accept: **arithmetic logic units**)

Set of 4: Frost

59. For how many years must soil stay below 0 degrees Celsius to be considered permafrost?

A: **two** years

60. In what U.S. state do the Frost, who won the Walter Cup in both of the PWWL's first two seasons, play?

A: **Minnesota**

61. What group, whose members include Sandy, the Easter Bunny, and Jack Frost, are the protagonists of a 2012 animated film titled for their "rise"?

A: the **Guardians**

62. In what poem does the declaration "Oh, I kept the first for another day!" refer to a fork in a path in a "yellow wood" traversed by Robert Frost?

A: "The **Road Not Taken**"

Jailbreak

63. A "Channel Slam" involves winning which two Grand Slam tennis tournaments?

A: **Wimbledon** Championship AND **French Open** (accept: **Roland Garros**)
(prompt: **French**)

64. The symbol of the fasces originates from what pre-Roman civilization in Italy?

A: **Etruscan** civilization (accept: the **Etruscans**)

65. A box dropped from a moving helicopter will continue to move in the direction of the helicopter due to what physical law, which loosely states that an object at rest will stay at rest?

A: **Newton's first** law of motion (accept: law of **inertia**)

66. Also nominated for an Emmy for directing the episode "Napkins", what actor stars as Sydney Adamu in *The Bear*?

A: Ayo **Edebiri**

67. What peninsula, which acts as a land bridge between Asia and Africa, is the only West Asian part of Egypt?

A: **Sinai** Peninsula

68. What substance's "activated" form is used in Brita filters to purify water?

A: **charcoal** (accept: **carbon**, reject: **C**)

69. What composer set the hymn "Veni creator spiritus" and the closing scene of *Faust* to music in his eighth symphony, nicknamed the "Symphony of a Thousand"?

A: Gustav **Mahler**

70. *Ludum Dare* is an example of what grassroots event, where participants work to create a video game from scratch in a very short period of time?

A: **game jam**

71. Who wrote *The Condition of the Working Class in England* and collaborated alongside Karl Marx in *The Communist Manifesto*?

A: Friedrich **Engels**

72. In geology, vitreous lustre is defined as the lustre of what substance, which can be produced by melting sand?

A: **glass**

73. What Canadian province or territory is the home of almost all speakers of Chiac, a blend of English and French?

A: **New Brunswick**

74. Emily Armstrong took over as the lead singer of what band seven years after the death of former lead singer Chester Bennington?

A: **Linkin Park**

75. The candy known as "Smarties" in the United States has what name in Canada?

A: **Rockets**

END OF THIRD QUARTER

FOURTH QUARTER

Jackpot

76.

Part 1: A director from what country criticized its contemporary cinema in an essay entitled "A Certain Tendency of" its "Cinema"?

Part 2: *The 400 Blows* is by a director from this country, which was also home to a "Left Bank" movement which included Agnes Varda.

Part 3: Films like *Breathless* are considered representative of this country's "New Wave" movement.

Part 4: This country was the origin of directors like Jean-Luc Godard and François Truffaut.

A: **France**

Set of 3: Connect

79. James Dow Allen and Victor Allis both independently solved what Hasbro game in which players drop yellow and red disks into a six-by-seven grid?

A: **Connect Four**

80. The epigraph "Only connect" appears at the end of what novel by E.M. Forster?

A: **Howards End**

81. Who designs the boards for the daily Connections game published by the New York Times?

A: Wyna **Liu**

Set of 4: Icebergs

82. A livestream by the Daily Star famously demonstrated that a head of iceberg lettuce outlasted what British Prime Minister's time in office?

A: Liz **Truss** (accept: Mary Elizabeth **Truss**)

83. In 1912, what White Star Line ship infamously sank when it hit an iceberg?

A: RMS **Titanic**

84. Many of the largest recorded icebergs have been calved from what largest ice shelf of Antarctica?

A: **Ross** Ice Shelf

85. What browser-based game spawned rumours that wearing a hard hat or using the Jackhammer 3000 could flip its Iceberg?

A: **Club Penguin**

15-Part Blitz

86. A gatra is meant to hold what blade, which must be worn at all times by Khalsa Sikhs?

A: **kirpan**

87. How many months were in the Roman calendar?

A: **10**

88. What first and last name is shared by the French Army officer who led the expedition that deposed Toussaint L'Ouverture and the Ferrari driver whose number is 16?

A: **Charles Leclerc**

89. What country's current king, Frederik X ["the tenth"], was crowned in January 2024 following Queen Margrethe II's abdication?

A: **Denmark**

90. The Travelling Symphony wanders performing Shakespeare after the Georgia Flu destroys civilization in what novel by Emily St. John Mandel?

A: **Station Eleven**

91. What substance is known as the "universal solvent"?

A: **water** (accept: **H2O**, **dihydrogen monoxide**)

92. What country's Line Islands skipped December 31st 1994, and as a result became the only nation to include a time zone of UTC +14:00 ["plus 14"]?

A: **Kiribati** ["KEE-ruh-bass"]

93. What Haligonian author wrote the *Game Changers* series, whose first two books were adapted into *Heated Rivalry*?

A: Rachel **Reid** (accept: Rachelle **Goguen**)

94. Until their overthrow, what political party led Syria until 2024 and Iraq until 2003?

A: **Ba'ath** Party (accept: **Ba'athists**)

95. What polysaccharide, which forms a matrix around cellulose fibres in a plant cell wall, is responsible for the characteristic consistency of some jellies?

A: **pectin**

96. What is the name of the former NBA team in Washington State that relocated to become the Oklahoma City Thunder?

A: Seattle **SuperSonics** (accept: Seattle **Sonics**) (prompt: Seattle)

97. What country's Sossusvlei salt pan is located in its namesake desert in southwest Africa?

A: **Namibia**

98. The first Wikipedia edit in space was made by what Artemis II astronaut, the first woman to journey around the Moon?

A: Christina **Koch** ["COOK"]

99. As recounted in a namesake 2025 song, Miami XO was teaching his little sister when what weapon supposedly killed his grandmother?

A: **bazooka**

100. Until February 28, approximately one quarter of oil trade passed through what geographic choke point, which since then has been repeatedly closed and reopened by Iran?

A: **Strait of Hormuz**

END OF GAME